CONFOEDERATIO,
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SETTLEMENT GAZETTEER OF POLOTSK, TUROV AND BELARUSIAN RUS (10000BC - 1300AD).

Archaeological Sites, Fortified Towns and Urban Population Estimates in North-Western Rus.

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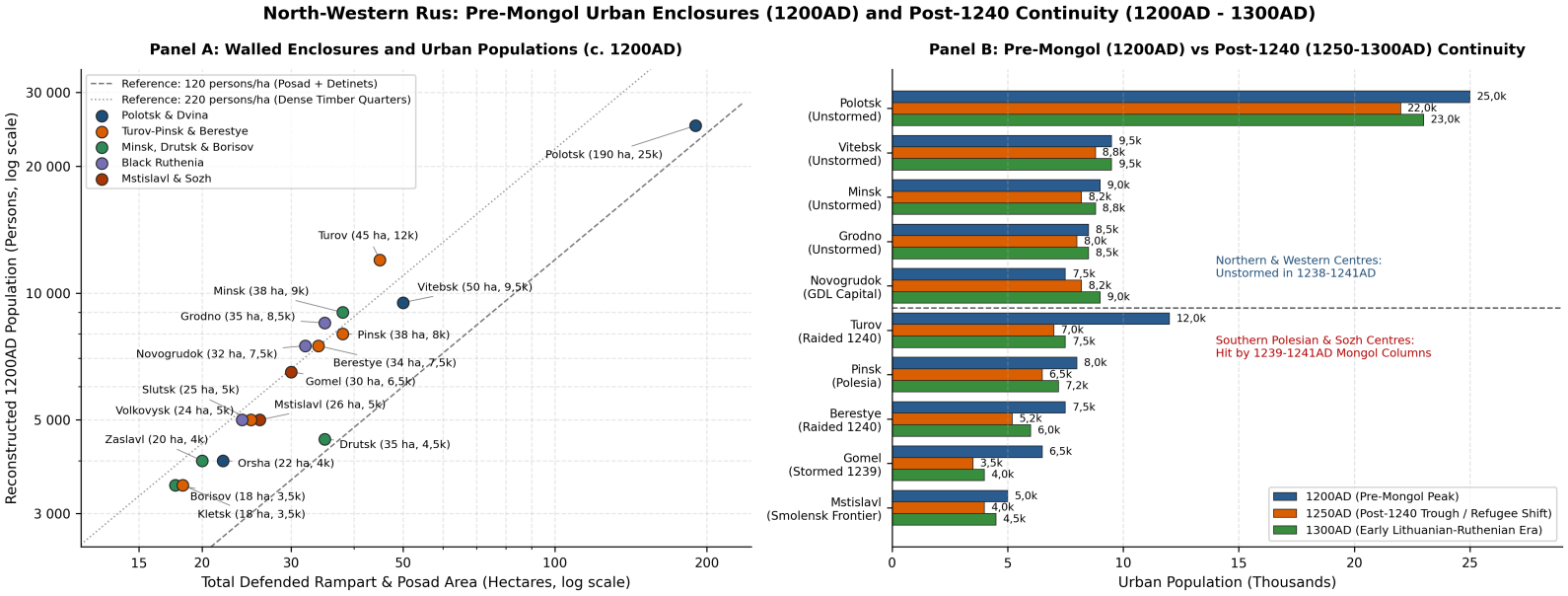


Figure 1. Walled Enclosures, Urban Populations and Post-1240 Settlement Continuity in North-Western Rus (1200AD - 1300AD).

Gazetteer Overview and Summary (172 Sites, 10000BC - 1300AD)

This document accompanies `polotsk_turov_and_belarusian_principalities_settlements.json`, the standardised Stadester settlement gazetteer for Region 4: North-Western Rus (Polotsk, Turov and Belarusian Rus), strictly book-ended at the Mongol Conquests (1238-1241AD) and the immediate post-conquest devolved principalities (1240AD - 1300AD). The gazetteer catalogues 172 distinct pre-Mongol chronicle towns, fortified *gorodishcha* and prehistoric and Iron Age archaeological type-sites across all five sub-regional clusters:

Sub-Regional Cluster (atlas_defacto Polity IDs)	Gazetteer Sites (N)	Major Capitals (>10 ha)	Secondary & Small Gorodishcha	Largest Settlement (1200AD / 1300AD)
0. Prehistoric, Bronze & Iron Age Type-Sites	24	1 (Menka)	23 (Palaeolithic - Early Slavic)	Menka (2,4k in 1000AD)
1. Polotsk, Vitebsk, Jersika & Koknese (2460, 2762, 2459, 3106)	34	8	26	Polotsk (25,0k / 23,0k)
2. Minsk, Drutsk & Borisov (2761, 2760, 2759)	24	6	18	Minsk (9,0k / 8,8k)
3. Turov, Pinsk, Kletsk, Dubrovytsia & Berestye (2855, 3051, 2920, 3050)	38	14	24	Turov (12,0k / 7,5k)
4. Black Ruthenia: Grodno, Novogrudok & Volkovysk (2826, 3183, 3184)	28	4	24	Grodno (8,5k) / Novogrudok (9,0k in 1300AD)
5. Mstislavl, Western Smolensk & Upper Sozh (3079)	24	6	18	Gomel (6,5k / 4,0k), Mstislavl (5,0k / 4,5k)
Total Gazetteer (Region 4, 10000BC - 1300AD)	172	39	133	Polotsk (25,0k at 1200AD; 23,0k at 1300AD)

Table 1. Regional Demographic and Archaeological Data Summary (Table 1).

All population entries in `polotsk_turov_and_belarusian_principalities_settlements.json` use strictly chronological benchmark keys within -10000 to 1300 (“-10000”, “-5000”, “-2500”, “-1200”, “-500”, “200”, “500”, “800”, “900”, “1000”, “1100”, “1150”, “1200”, “1240”, “1250”, “1300”) and store strictly positive integers (> 0).

Estimation Methodology by Historical Horizon (10000BC - 1300AD)

Prehistoric, Neolithic, Bronze Age and Iron Age Sites (10000BC - 500AD)

For the 24 prehistoric and Iron Age type-sites (type: “archaeological_site”), site populations are derived from excavated dwelling counts, cultural layer area (m^2 or ha) and palaeodemographic household multipliers (5 - 7 persons per hearth or pit-dwelling) established by M. M. Charniauski, U. F. Isaenko, A. G. Mitrofanov and L. D. Pobol [1][2][3][4]:

- **Final Palaeolithic and Mesolithic Camps** (10000BC - 5000BC): *Yurevichi* (51,9442°N, 29,5314°E) on the Pripyat, *Berdizh* (52,8331°N, 30,9325°E) and *Grensk* (52,9711°N, 30,8922°E) on the Sozh, *Korma*, *Ankovichi* and *Borok* represent reindeer- and mammoth-hunter base camps of 40 - 65 residents at 10000BC, expanding to 70 - 110 inhabitants in Mesolithic lacustrine settlements at 5000BC.
- **Neolithic Pile Dwellings and Flint-Mining Settlements** (5000BC - 2500BC): The waterlogged pile-dwelling cluster of Asavets (*Krivina peat bog*, 54,9614°N, 29,4231°E), Kryvina 1 and the Krasnoselsky flint-mining complex (53,2642°N, 24,4319°E) supported semi-permanent communities of 160 - 340 inhabitants across 5000BC - 2500BC.

- **Bronze Age and Iron Age Hillforts** (1200BC - 500AD): Large lowland enclosures of the Milograd and Zarubintsy cultures in southern Belarus (*Milograd* 480 at 500BC, *Chaplin* 560 at 200AD, *Goroshkov* 490 at 200AD, *Mokhov* 450 at 500AD) outsized the smaller fortified promontory hillforts of the Brushed Pottery and Dnieper-Dvina cultures (*Malyshki* 350 at 200AD, *Zazony* 320 at 200AD, *Bancerovshchina* 490 at 500AD).
- **The Menka Complex** (menka_gorodishche, 800AD - 1300AD): Located at the confluence of the Menka and Dunai streams 16 km west of modern Minsk, the *Menka* complex (1,5 ha ramparted hillfort and 40,0 ha open craft settlement excavated by E. M. Zagorulsky) served as the initial tribal and early Rurikid centre of *Mensk* (850 in 800AD, 1 600 in 900AD, peaking at 2 400 in 1000AD) before the 1067AD Battle on the Nemiga River and the transfer of the princely seat to the Svisloch-Nemiga *Zamchishche* (minsk), declining thereafter to an unfortified rural *selyshche* (950 in 1100AD; 500 in 1200AD; 420 in 1300AD) [5].

Pre-Mongol Kievan Rus and Post-1240 Principality Centres (800AD - 1300AD)

For the 148 fortified medieval towns and *gorodishcha* active between 800AD and 1300AD, urban populations are calibrated from archaeologically surveyed fortified areas (*Detinets* (*Zamchishche*) plus *Okolny Gorod*) and unfortified craft suburbs (*Posady*), applying the homestead density models of G. V. Shtykhov (1975, 1992), S. V. Tarasov (1998), P. F. Lysenko (1974, 1985, 2004), E. M. Zagorulsky (1982, 2001), F. D. Gurevich (1981), Ya. G. Zverugo (1989) and A. V. Kuza (1989, 1996) (110 - 150 persons/ha inside densely built timber-street *detinets* and *okolny gorod* quarters and 60 - 90 persons/ha across outer *posady*) [6][7][8][9][10][11][12]:

Settlement (snake_case Key)	Principality (Polity ID)	Coordinates (Lat, Lon)	Area (1200AD)	1000AD	1100AD	1200AD	1250AD	1300AD
polotsk (Polotsk)	Polotsk (2460)	55,4879, 28,7856	190,0 ha	10 000	18 000	25 000	22 000	23 000
turov (Turov)	Turov (2855)	52,0692, 27,7358	45,0 ha	6 500	9 200	12 000	7 000	7 500
vitebsk (Vitebsk)	Vitebsk (2762)	55,1904, 30,2049	50,0 ha	4 200	6 800	9 500	8 800	9 500
minsk (Minsk (Mensk))	Minsk (2761)	53,9006, 27,5590	38,0 ha	1 500	5 200	9 000	8 200	8 800
grodno (Grodno (Goroden))	Grodno (2826)	53,6884, 23,8258	35,0 ha	2 800	5 500	8 500	8 000	8 500
pinsk (Pinsk (Pinesk))	Pinsk (3051)	52,1153, 26,1031	38,0 ha	2 500	5 000	8 000	6 500	7 200
brest_berestye (Berestye)	Berestye Land	52,0975, 23,6877	34,0 ha	2 800	5 000	7 500	5 200	6 000
novogrudok (Novogrudok)	Novogrudok (3183)	53,5942, 25,8192	32,0 ha	2 200	4 800	7 500	8 200	9 000
gomel (Gomel (Homiy))	Lower Sozh	52,4345, 30,9754	30,0 ha	3 200	4 800	6 500	3 500	4 000
mstislavl (Mstislavl)	Mstislavl (3079)	54,0203, 31,7258	26,0 ha	750	1 800	5 000	4 000	4 500

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Settlement (snake_case Key)	Principality (Polity ID)	Coordinates (Lat, Lon)	Area (1200AD)	1000AD	1100AD	1200AD	1250AD	1300AD
slutsk (Slutsk (Sluchesk))	Turov & Slutsk	53,0275, 27,5594	25,0 ha	1 800	3 200	5 000	4 300	4 800
volkovysk (Volkovysk)	Volkovysk (3184)	53,1561, 24,4514	24,0 ha	1 800	3 300	5 000	4 700	5 100
drutsk (Drutsk)	Drutsk (2760)	54,3414, 29,7547	35,0 ha	1 800	3 100	4 500	4 100	4 300
orsha (Orsha (Rsha))	Vitebsk (2762)	54,5081, 30,4172	22,0 ha	1 500	2 700	4 000	3 600	3 900
zaslavl (Zaslavl (Izyaslavl))	Polotsk & Minsk	54,0003, 27,2917	20,0 ha	2 200	3 100	4 000	3 600	3 800
borisov (Borisov)	Borisov (2759)	54,2279, 28,5050	18,0 ha	-	1 800	3 500	3 200	3 400
kletsk (Kletsk)	Kletsk (2920)	53,0636, 26,6322	18,0 ha	1 200	2 200	3 500	3 000	3 300
dubrovytsia (Dubrovytsia)	Dubrovytsia (3050)	51,5744, 26,5650	18,0 ha	1 100	2 200	3 500	2 200	2 500
mozyr (Mozyr)	Turov (2855)	52,0494, 29,2456	16,5 ha	1 200	2 200	3 500	2 100	2 500
lukoml (Lukoml)	Polotsk (2460)	54,7078, 29,1497	15,0 ha	1 500	2 500	3 500	3 100	3 300
logoisk (Logoisk (Logozhsk))	Polotsk (2460)	54,2006, 27,8489	15,0 ha	1 300	2 400	3 500	3 100	3 300
slonim (Slonim (Uslonim))	Volkovysk (3184)	53,0869, 25,3164	15,0 ha	1 200	2 300	3 500	3 300	3 600
braslav (Braslav (Bryachislavl))	Polotsk (2460)	55,6419, 27,0419	13,5 ha	1 100	2 000	3 000	2 700	2 900
david_gorodok (David-Gorodok)	Turov & Pinsk	52,0558, 27,2133	14,0 ha	850	1 800	3 000	2 200	2 500
rogachev (Rogachev)	Turov (2855)	53,0833, 30,0500	14,0 ha	1 000	1 900	3 000	2 000	2 300
krichev (Krichev (Krechut))	Smolensk & Mstislavl	53,7131, 31,7139	13,5 ha	950	1 900	3 000	2 200	2 500
usvyaty (Usvyaty)	Polotsk & Vitebsk	55,7469, 30,7539	13,0 ha	1 000	1 900	2 800	2 500	2 600
kopys (Kopys)	Vitebsk & Orsha	54,3239, 30,2928	12,5 ha	900	1 800	2 800	2 500	2 600
bragin (Bragin)	Turov (2855)	51,7878, 30,2678	12,5 ha	900	1 800	2 800	1 500	1 800

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Settlement (snake_case Key)	Principality (Polity ID)	Coordinates (Lat, Lon)	Area (1200AD)	1000AD	1100AD	1200AD	1250AD	1300AD
slavgorod_propoisk (Propoisk)	Smolensk & Mstislavl	53,4439, 31,0014	12,5 ha	950	1 800	2 800	2 000	2 300
jersika (Jersika (Gerzike))	Jersika (2459)	56,2528, 26,1964	13,5 ha	1 200	1 900	2 500	1 200	1 100
svisloch_berezina (Svisloch)	Minsk (2761)	53,4289, 28,9781	12,0 ha	900	1 600	2 500	2 100	2 300
kopyl (Kopyl)	Kletsk & Slutsk	53,1500, 27,0917	11,5 ha	850	1 600	2 500	2 200	2 400
rechitsa (Rechitsa)	Turov & Chernigov	52,3617, 30,3917	11,0 ha	850	1 600	2 500	1 500	1 800
stepan_horyn (Stepan)	Dubrovytsia (3050)	51,1286, 26,3042	10,0 ha	800	1 450	2 200	1 500	1 750
loev_gora (Loev Gorodishche)	Turov & Chernigov	51,9458, 30,7953	9,5 ha	980	1 500	2 100	1 100	1 300
koknese (Koknese (Kukenois))	Koknese (3106)	56,6406, 25,4194	10,0 ha	950	1 500	2 000	1 200	1 300
kobrin (Kobrin)	Berestye Land	52,2139, 24,3564	9,5 ha	750	1 350	2 000	1 650	1 950
chechersk (Chechersk)	Sozh Corridor	52,9167, 30,9167	9,5 ha	720	1 350	2 000	1 300	1 550
mogilev_zmeevka (Mogilev)	Drutsk & Smolensk	53,9000, 30,3333	9,0 ha	850	1 350	1 950	1 650	2 100
kamenets (Kamenets (Belaya Vezha))	Berestye & Volhynia	52,4008, 23,8194	12,0 ha	-	650	1 200	1 800	3 000

Table 2. Regional Demographic and Archaeological Data Summary (Table 2).

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